

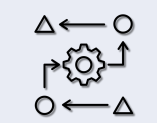
Team - 43

SPG

GP-2 REPORT



*Beyond Time Zones : How Unconscious Cultural
Assumptions Impact Remote Team Success*



Methodology

Qualitative analysis of individuals' behavior and their opinions and experiences have been carried out through interviews, scenario building and analysis.

1

PRIMARY DATA:

Digital meetings (GMeet) were carried out with participants from a wide variety of backgrounds and environments, with experience in a multitude of industries and work scenarios.



2

SCENARIO SURVEYS:

Participants presented with multiple simulated scenarios to study their behaviour and opinions under different settings.



3

SECONDARY SOURCES

Following Articles Used:

- American Psychological Association. (n.d.). Addressing bias, stigma, and discrimination in a virtual work environment.
- Donald, B. B., & Brody, M. A. (2023). Toward a more perfect union: Overcoming division, discrimination, and distance through the rule of law. Fordham Law Review, 91(6).
- GeerthofstedeGeert Hofstede and Gert Jan Hofstede on culture



4

DEMOGRAPHICS

Reserarch Team : 5 members

Interviewees : 5

Participants

Material: March 20–23, 2026



5

DATES

Start :

20th March, 2026

End : 23rd March, 2026





Key Insights

- **Cultural differences shape communication and credibility**

Language nuances, communication styles (direct vs indirect), and perceptions of authority vary across regions, affecting understanding and interactions.

- **Cultural competence and trust require adaptation and experience**

Effective collaboration—especially in remote settings—depends on lived experience, adaptability, and deliberate efforts to build clarity and rapport.

- **Biases are sustained and propagate in various mannerisms**

People can hold biases and discriminatory attitude towards others on a wide basis, not all which can be effectively combated. Often marginalizing policies in work places go beyond the classic race, gender, caste, etc. categories.

- **Variation in participation pattern results in inequality in participation.**

Expressive/ Extroverted individuals tend to dominate social discussions, professional meetings while quite introverted individuals get overshadowed. Its not about caliber but about different cultural norms about speaking.

- **Language and participation differences create hidden inequality**

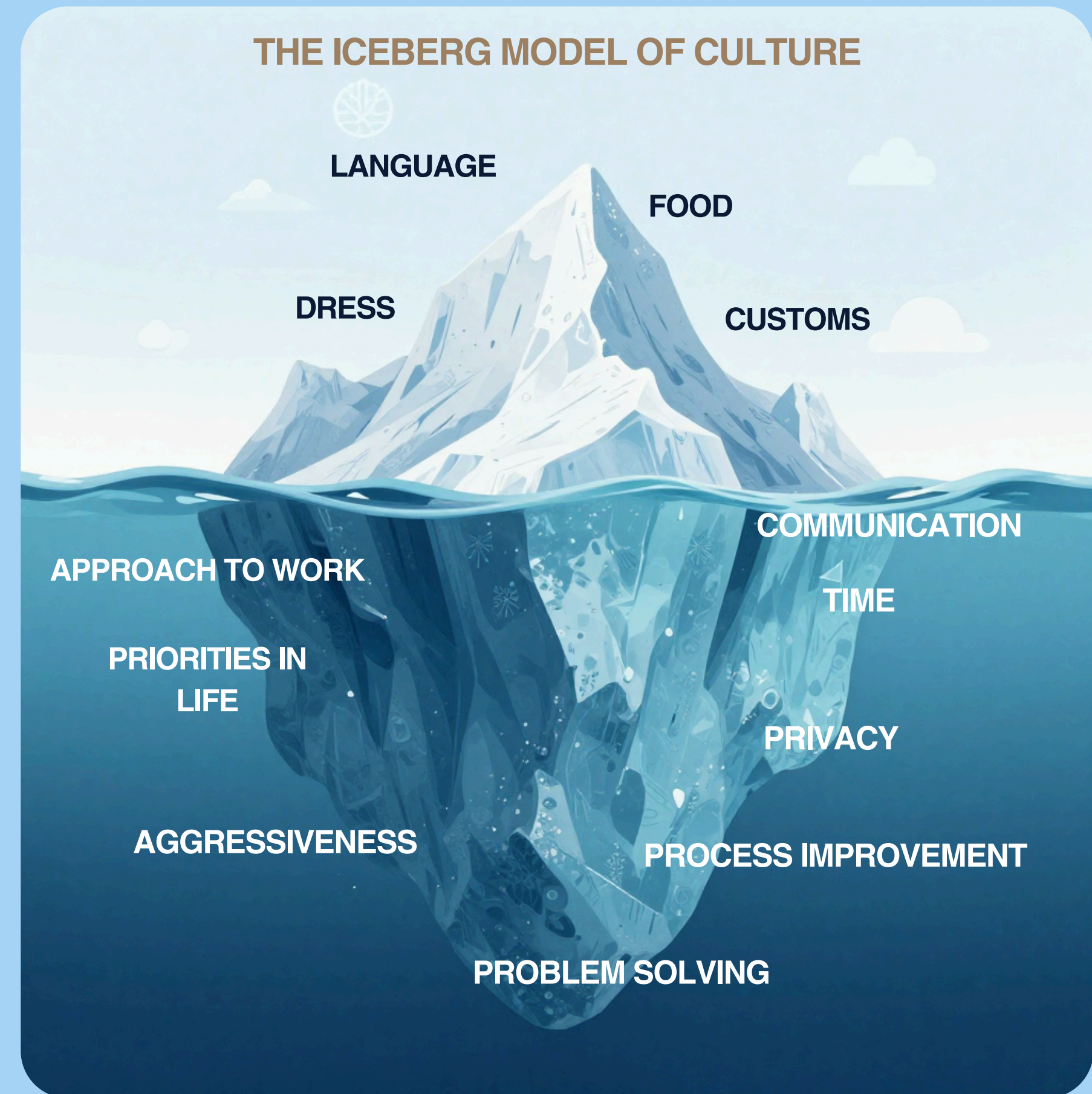
Variations in language proficiency and communication styles affect participation levels in meetings. Individuals who are less expressive or face language barriers are often overlooked, leading to reduced visibility despite meaningful contributions.





Recommendations

- **Build cultural competence through learning, adaptation, and organizational support**
Encourage continuous cultural learning, adapt communication styles, and provide support systems like training, translators, and mentorship to enable effective cross-cultural collaboration.
- **Strengthen trust through inclusive and intentional communication**
Use clear, empathetic communication—especially in remote settings—while fostering inclusion (e.g., celebrating festivals) and leveraging shared interests to build rapport.
- **Mass Education towards harmful effects of biases and discrimination**
People must be made aware of the negative effects of discriminatory policies and how they affect and diminish work flow, efficiency and promote disharmony at work place
- **Establish clear communication norms to reduce misinterpretation**
Teams should define expectations around response time, feedback style, and meeting etiquette. Clear norms help minimize ambiguity and ensure that behaviors are interpreted consistently across different cultural contexts.



Application/Influence Model

How Unconscious Cultural Assumptions Impact Remote Team Success

Real-World Application:

In global remote teams, members are from different cultural backgrounds and have to interact often through virtual platforms. Based on the study, differences in communication styles and misinterpretation of behavior creates friction that affects team performance.



CASE STUDY: *Communication and Trust in Global Virtual Teams ~ Jarvenpaa & Leidner*

Global virtual teams begin with high initial trust, but cultural differences in communication styles, response times, and participation behaviors generate interpretation biases (e.g., delayed responses perceived as disinterest, direct feedback as rudeness), progressively eroding trust, reducing participation, and causing team inefficiency unless cultural differences are proactively addressed.

Factor	Observation	Interpretation Bias	Impact on Team
Response time	Some respond quickly, others late	Slow response seen as lack of interest	Reduced inclusion in discussions
Communication style	Direct vs indirect feedback	Direct seen as rude, indirect seen as unclear	Misunderstanding and friction
Meeting participation	Some speak actively, others remain silent	Silence seen as disengagement	Unequal participation
Visibility	Active speakers are more noticed	Quiet contributors undervalued	Recognition imbalance
Language/expression	Accent or phrasing differences	Judged as lack of competence	Reduced confidence
Regional perception	Stereotyping	Disrespect	Bias in decision making

Team Contributions & Roles

All team members contributed to each deliverable. Once tasks were defined, they were taken up and owned by team members to ensure smooth execution and timely completion.

1

Sharmila L [Team Lead]

Led overall planning, task breakdown and allocation. Contributed and compiled Team Contract (TC) and GP1 reports, and developed the contingency plan, project timeline, and team profile. Contributed to interview question design, project review, and closure in GP2, along with analysis and recommendations.

2

Prashanth [Interview Lead]

Contributed to the development of the Team Contract (TC). In GP1, defined project objectives and scope. In GP2, led the end-to-end interview process, including question compilation, quality assurance, and team alignment. Compiled and contributed significantly to analysis and recommendations.

5

Vidhya [Live Presentation Lead]

Contributed to the Team Contract (TC) and in GP1 supported the design of the Work Breakdown Structure (WBS). In GP2, handled final report design and compilation and will lead the video presentation.

4

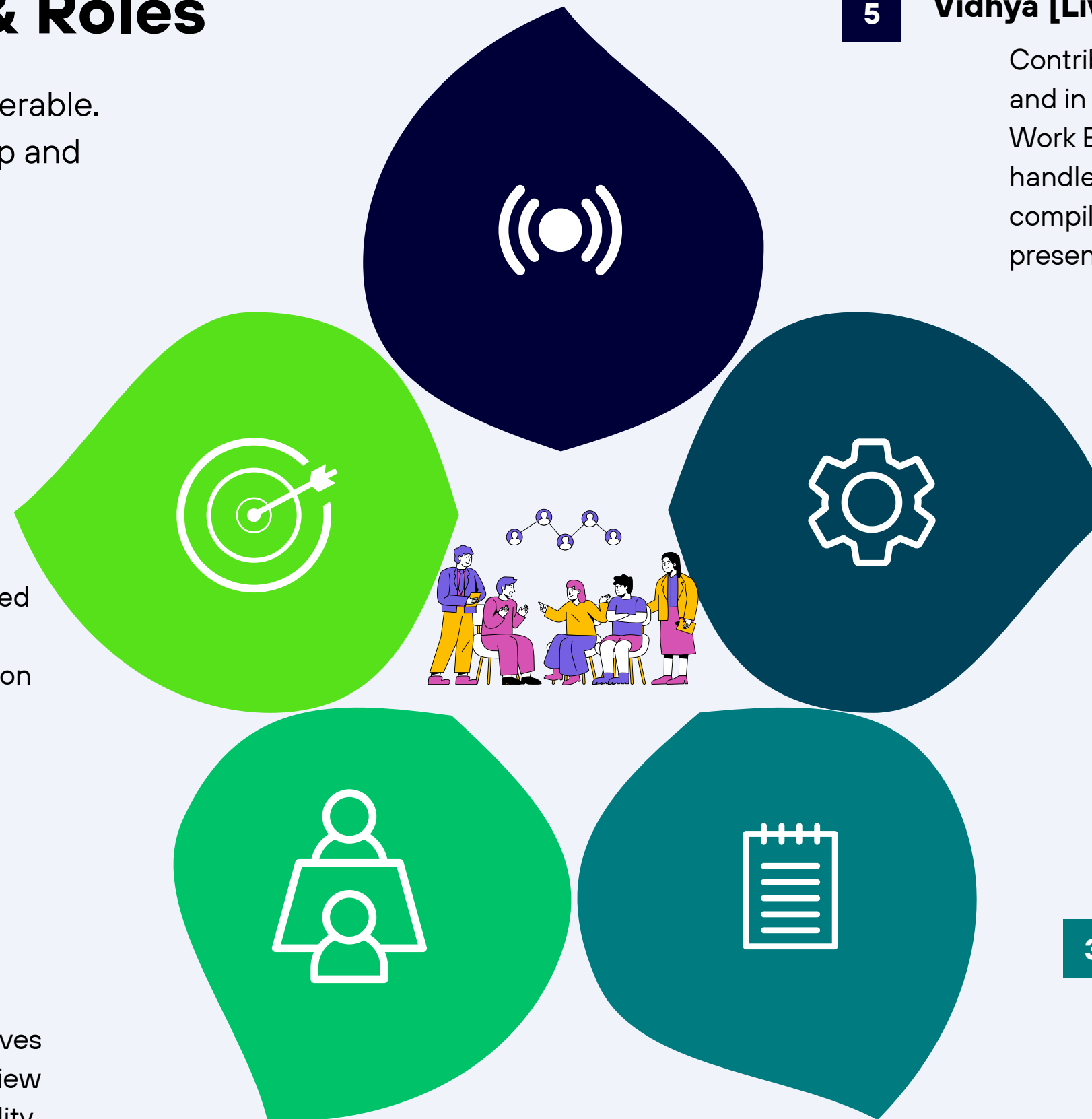
Priyangshu [Research Lead]

Contributed to the Team Contract (TC) and in GP1 identified the project title and key secondary resources. Led GP2 report planning from task assignment through completion and designed the overall methodology. Also contributed to analysis and recommendations.

3

Arun Barwa [Data collection Lead]

Contributed to the Team Contract (TC) and collaborated on defining project objectives and scope. In GP2, managed the application of influence models and structured pre-interview data collection to organize inputs for effective analysis. Also contributed to analysis and recommendations.



Thankyou

We sincerely thank all participants for sharing their perspectives and experiences, which have greatly enriched our GP2 report.

Thank you to the IIT Madras team for your time and guidance to make this segment of our project a success!